UNIT 14: ENVIRONMENTAL CONCERNS

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14.0 OBJECTIVES

In this Unit, you will be reading about the environmental concerns of India in a globalising and rapidly integrating world. After reading this Unit, you will be able to:

- establish the relationship between globalisation and environment;
- discuss the harmful effects, direct as well as indirect, of globalisation on the environment;
- identify the North-South knowledge divide and its dynamics;
- elaborate few major global environmental initiatives;
- discuss the contribution India has made in the direction of cleaner environment; and
- provide some steps which can help India tackle its environmental concerns.

14.1 INTRODUCTION

In a globalised world, the boundaries between states are less visible; and political, economic, cultural and social events are more interconnected with far-reaching impact. We all experience diverse effects of globalisation. It has led to easy and fast access to technology and innovation. Debates on environmentalism do not lack the extensive importance attached to globalisation. Green activists include globalisation as their main agenda. The damage caused to ecosystem from the oil that spilled from one of the leaking containers of British Petroleum in 2010 is just one of the examples of the threat globalization poses to the environment. Climate change, deforestation, pollution are now, few of the many, widely used expressions in international relations as we have achieved the era of the resource wars. The environment and natural resources are deeply related with security, which was and will always remain one of the most controversial concepts of international politics. Certain countries over-consume energy while others under-consume. Consumption levels around the globe have reached such high levels that Earth is struggling to keep up with the regeneration required for us to maintain our high consumption levels. Hence, the international agencies which have been created for protecting the environment would have to revisit their concerns and are required to show a strong will to implement the decisions in this direction.

14.2 GLOBALISATION AND ENVIRONMENT

We feel our lifestyles have been altered by the process of globalisation. We are globally consuming more products, burning more fossil fuels, discarding more clothes and piling more electronic waste. This all has impacted the ecological cycle as increased consumerism leads to high levels of production which requires more extraction and transportation of raw materials and that in turn leads to high carbon footprints. Extractivism and stress on transportation has led to the added strain on the non-renewable sources of energy. The waste generated from production gets dumped in the oceans which adversely affects the sea life. The incidents where sea animals are found dead on the shores are not rare now. Foreign foods are preferred more than the locally-grown food. The genetic makeup of the plants is also getting affected due to toxic waste disposal. Plastic is very useful for packaging

and preserving the products which are exported. While many studies have found that plastic is non-biodegradable and one of the major toxic pollutants, we still continue to use it in various ways. There are innumerable examples and incidents which clearly suggest that the globalisation has made irreversible changes to our lives and has also led to some major concerns, environment in particular.

The literature on environmental effects of globalisation mainly talks about two types of effects i.e., direct and indirect effects. The direct effects include emissions and environmental damage which is related to extraction and the physical movement of goods from exporters to importers. This largely includes emissions from fossil fuel use. Simultaneously there are numerous indirect effects that are caused due to the growth in trade and foreign direct investment. These indirect effects are classified in three categories: composition, scale and technique effects. The scale effect indicates that the global production possibilities frontier shifts due to the more efficient allocation of resources within countries. This increases the size of the industrial pollution base which means there will be greater global emissions other things being equal. The composition effect measures changes in emissions which arise as a result of trade liberalisation as the country's industrial composition changes. For example, if liberalization expands the service sector of a country while the heavy industry contracts, then the country's total emissions will most probably fall as the sector which is expanding is less emission intensive. Finally, the technique effect refers to the glut of channels through which globalisation impacts the rate at which the pollution increases by the industry and the households. These channels include changes in the environmental regulations and their stringency. Such changes are in response to income growth or the political climate surrounding such regulations. The technique effect also includes the technology transfer which is facilitated by trade or we can say by globalisation.

14.3 GLOBAL ENVIRONMENTAL ISSUES AND INITIATIVES

The environment is undoubtedly the most global and multidimensional issue in the international system. Climate change is a cause of concern for the mankind as it has serious and various catastrophic economic, ecological and environmental implications. And so, it demands immediate action. It is a common knowledge that due to climate change we experience many disasters. The frequency and the severity of climate related disasters is on an increase. Hurricanes like Katrina in USA, Tsunamis in South Asia, Earthquakes in Afghanistan and India, and Typhoon Tokage in Japan are a few examples of the disasters from the recent past.

Environment was not as polluted as it is now and so the concerns were also negligible. It is only recently, one can say after the Second World War, that environmental movements have become very active. We can also look at it from the perspective that this rise in environmental movement is closely linked to the phenomenon of globalization as globalisation has transformed the structure of the international system. The international and trans-boundary dimensions of environmental issues have been realised by the governments and individuals due to the phenomenon of globalization.

Beginning with the UN Conference on the Environment held in Stockholm, Sweden in 1972, there has been an increasing movement towards the adoption of international instruments as tools for environmental protection. Global climate system is a 'common' resource and looking at the catastrophic implications of global warming induced climate change its utmost care becomes a collective global responsibility. This can be managed only through a multilateral treaty like the Montreal Protocol adopted in 1987 to protect the ozone layer. United Nations (UN) has to its credit two major achievements in this respect. They are: United Nations Framework Convention on Climate Change (UNFCCC) and The Kyoto Protocol.

14.3.1 UNFCCC

UN initiated negotiations, in 1991, to take care of climate system through adoption of a convention. The UNFCCC is an international environmental treaty which was adopted on 9 May 1992. It was opened for signature at the Earth Summit in Rio de Janeiro from 3 to 14 June 1992. After that it entered into force on 21 March 1994, after a sufficient number of countries had ratified it. The UNFCCC objective is to stabilize greenhouse gas (GHG) concentrations in the atmosphere at a level that would prevent dangerous anthropogenic interference with the climate system. The convention has adopted the notion of common but differentiated responsibility. This framework has set non-binding limits on greenhouse gas emissions for individual countries. No enforcement mechanisms are mentioned in the framework. But, the framework outlines how particular international treaties, which are called protocols or agreements, may be negotiated to decide and specify further action towards the main objective of the UNFCCC. The UNFCCC has 196 Parties (States) plus the European Union as of November 2019. Due to nearly universal membership, the convention enjoys broad legitimacy. The parties to the convention meet annually in Conferences of the Parties (COP) to assess the progress with respect to climate change and to adopt, if needed, new measures. COP is the supreme decision making body of the Convention. To date, 24 COPs have been held, the last one was in

Katowice, Poland in December 2018. UN's pursuance for a multilateral protocol on this issue promoted two broad groups of governments like the North-South divide. Now these groups are popularly known as Annex I countries which include developed countries and transition economies like Russia and Ukraine. The group of developing countries is known as Non-Annex I countries. UNFCCC asked the signatory countries to calculate the national level inventories of GHG emissions.

14.3.2 Kyoto Protocol

The details of protocol were decided in the third round at Kyoto, Japan in December 1997. The Kyoto Protocol was opened for signature in 1998 but it came into effect only on February 16, 2005. First commitment period expired in 2012. The USA and Australia refused to ratify this protocol. Thirty-eight developed countries which are Annex I countries, had ratified the protocol. They had legal binding to cut down the emissions of GHGs by 5.2 percent of their base level total emissions by 2012 which was the end of first commitment period. The non-Annex I countries, which are the developing countries also had ratified the protocol but have no emissions limit to adhere to. They were to cooperate in the reduction of GHGs emissions. The Kyoto Protocol to the UNFCCC had devised three 'Flexibility Mechanisms' to enhance cooperation and assist parties to meet their emissions reduction targets in a given time frame.

(a) Emissions Trading (ET): As per Article 17 of the protocol, Annex I nations are allowed to trade emissions reductions among themselves or selling credits towards their commitments.

(b) Joint Implementation (JI): As per Article 6 of the protocol, collaboration between Annex I nations is allowed on projects that would reduce carbon emissions. Such projects earn emissions-reduction credits for the nations involved.

(c) The Clean Development Mechanisms (CDM): Further, Article 12 provides incentives to those firms which intend to invest in those projects which target reduction in emissions in the developing countries. The credits resulting from such projects are called Certified Emissions Reductions (CERs). Such credits get shared between the host country and the firm which invested in that project. As against the 'Command and Control' interventions regime, the protocol prefers 'Market-based Instruments', to manage the emissions-based climate change issue.

First two mechanisms have focused on developed Annex I countries. Emissions Trading and Joint Implementation, both are expected to work economically and effectively in realising the targeted level of GHGs emissions in a given timeframe. CDM is concentrating on cooperation and partnership between developed and developing countries. This mechanism is expecting that not only governments in developed countries but also the multinational firms will be encouraged to help the third world countries through suitable projects - afforestation, transfer and adaptation of technology related projects – to support the efforts of the developing countries. The levels of national GHGs emissions which were identified by all the signatory nations of UNFCCC were used to create the 1990 benchmark levels for accession of Annex I countries to the Kyoto Protocol and for the commitment of those countries to GHG reductions. Updated inventories of GHGs emissions are submitted annually by Annex I countries.

The Protocol was amended in 2012 to encompass the period 2013–2020 in the **Doha Amendment**, which as of December 2015 had not entered into force as only 31 countries had ratified the amendment, instead of the requirement of ratification by 144 countries.

14.3.3Paris Agreement

Representatives of 196 state parties at the 21st Conference of the Parties of the UNFCCC met in Le Bourget, near Paris, and adopted by consensus the Paris Agreement on 12 December 2015. The Paris Agreement entered into force on 4 November 2016. As of March 2019, 195 UNFCCC members had signed the agreement, and 187 were become party to it.

The central aim of this agreement is to strengthen the global response to the threat of climate change by keeping a global temperature rise this century well below 2 degrees Celsius above pre-industrial levels and to pursue efforts to limit the temperature increase even further to 1.5 degrees Celsius. The agreement also aims to strengthen the ability of countries to deal with the impacts of climate change. As per UNFCCC, to reach these ambitious goals, appropriate financial flows, a new technology framework and an enhanced capacity building framework will be put in place in order to support action by developing countries and the most vulnerable countries.

Under the Paris Agreement, each country must determine, plan, and regularly report on the contribution that it undertakes to mitigate global warming. No mechanism forces a country to set a specific target by a specific date, but each target should go beyond previously set targets. In June

2017, US President Donald Trump announced his intention to withdraw the United States from the agreement. Under the agreement, the earliest effective date of withdrawal for the US is November 2020, shortly before the end of President Trump's 2016 term. In practice, changes in United States policy that are contrary to the Paris Agreement have already been put in place.

Trade, being an integral part of globalisation, has direct effect on environment. Globalization has only been possible through multilateral negotiations which took place with the help of World Trade Organization (WTO). Although environmental protection is not part of the WTO's core mandate, but still it has encouraged some interest within its member countries for sustainable development and environment friendly trade policies. If one reads about WTO, it will be easily observed that there are several WTO trade-related measures that are compatible with environmental protection and sustainable use of natural resources. The WTO direct countries, under its green provisions, to protect human, animal or plant life and conserve their exhaustible natural resources. Apart from the WTO, regional trade agreements are another characteristic of globalization that promote environmentally sustainable policies. The countries which seek to join such regional agreements, are also made to embrace environmental cooperation agreements simultaneously. Many countries in European Union have developed national policies that stipulate that environmental impact assessments must be carried out prior to signing any trade agreement.

Check Your Progress Exercise 1

Note: i) Use the space given below for your answer.

ii) See the end of the unit for tips for your answer.

1) Explain the direct and indirect environmental effects of globalisation.

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2) Briefly discuss UNFCC and the Kyoto Protocol.

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14.4 THE INTERNATIONAL STAGE

For the first time in 2007, UN Security Council conducted a meeting to discuss the climate change issue. This issue is also a recurrent theme in the G20 Summits of the previous years. At the 2014 Davos World Economic Forum, major public panel sessions were dedicated to the discussion of vital issues from environmental perspective like future natural resources extraction in a sustainable world, global food security, resilience to natural disasters, climate change, etc. Another example which demonstrates that the environmental issues have played a prominent role on the international stage is the China-US Climate Agreement which was announced in November 2014.

To remain competitive in this globalised world, the international firms feel forced to adopt cost-saving production techniques which are generally harmful to the environment. On the other hand, we observe the anti-globalization sentiments heating up in the United States itself, which was once the strongest architect and proponent of globalization in the world. A good example of this is the case of Iran, which has been slapped with economic sanctions. This makes Iran less integrated in the world economy. But does this political and economy-oriented step of the US do any good to the environment? The answer is no. The result has been the domestic production that has caused immense havoc on the environment. As result of import bans of crude oil, for example, Iran has started refining its own crude oil that contains ten times the level of pollutants of the oil it used to import.

If we look at China, the evidence suggest that its economic growth has come with a relatively lesser increase in emissions as compared to what had happened earlier in Europe and North America. The reason is that China has been able to “leapfrog” to those technologies which are much cleaner than those which were used by Europe and North America at similar stages in their development. China’s emissions are high but it is making tremendous gains in reducing their emissions, particularly after becoming more integrated into the world economy. Global market access has provided major

incentives to China due to which it has moved from the position of one of the world's top polluters into a global leader which is fighting against climate change and pollution. In 2017, China shut down many factories which were not complying with its policy of environmental standards.

Apart from China, The European Union has started an initiative which has the objective to reduce the negative environmental impacts generated by the use of natural resources, decoupling growth and environmental impact. Similarly, the UK has indicated a shift towards a *One Planet Economy*, with the start of the government's new UK Sustainable Development Framework. Sweden has also pledged to become the first *oil-free nation* by 2020 by switching to alternative fuels.

In contrast, the US is slowly drifting away from the climate change fight in part because of the anti-globalization inclinations of their current president, Donald Trump. He pulled the US out of the Paris Agreement on climate change in keeping with his anti-globalization campaign. Through its America First Energy Plan, the Trump administration has outlined its preference for polluting industries, the use of fossil fuels and the revival of the coal industry.

14.4.1 North-South Divide

The issues on which attention is focused are often far from the experience of environmental degradation of poor people in hamlets, villages, towns, and mega-cities in large parts of the world, where "the 'environment' consists of problems associated with health, shelter, and food availability" (Redclift and Sage, 1998: 501). India's prime minister Indira Gandhi had reminded the world at the 1972 UN Conference on Environment at Stockholm that tackling poverty is a bigger task than environment for countries like India. She was establishing a link between poverty and environment when she famously said: 'Poverty is the greatest polluter'.

The wealthy developed countries are collectively known as the North while the poorer developing countries as well as the least developed countries are together known as the South. The South prioritises the above-mentioned issues as the environmental concerns while the environmental issues addressed by governance at the global level tend to be those on the priority agenda of the North (Agarwal, Narain, and Sharma, 1999; Gutman, 1994). These issues are mostly of global character which often includes climate change, ozone depletion, and biodiversity.

The issues which the South prioritizes, are less visible on the global agenda. Such invisibility of

environmental issues prioritized by the South can be related to the North-South power gradient. The present international system is such that the more powerful countries set the environmental agenda.

But it can also be argued that Northern dominance with respect to setting the agenda is often supported by the invocation of science. Most of the data and evidence which is assembled at the global level and further incorporated into global models, is not generated in the south and tropical latitudes but in the developed countries or we can say the North. Hence, the assessments may be less effective for environmental problems in the South. For example, due to the possibility to have strict safety conditions while using a pesticide, significant risks can be avoided in the developed countries while in the developing countries the farmers may pose significant risks to their health due to low education and awareness levels as well as lack of the availability of the protective gear.

What weakens the position of the developing countries in various multilateral negotiations as well as their participation is the lack of national scientific capacity. Even in the global institutions such as the IPCC, there is a huge disparity in North-South participation. In the 1996 IPCC Working Group I there were 158 authors from the U.S., 61 from the U.K., 3 from India, and 7 from China. The relative participation looked similar in Working Group II. Working Group III had 30 participants from the United States, 5 from the United Kingdom, 7 from India, and 2 from China (Kandlikar and Sagar, 1999). Hence it is imperative to increase the generation of scientific knowledge in the South and of the South. Four strategies could be pursued in this direction: (1) strengthening the data and science foundations of the South; (2) strengthening the scientific community in the South; (3) encouraging more research on the South among Northern scientists; and (4) expanding the groups capable of generating scientific knowledge.

14.5 INDIA AND ENVIRONMENT

India has the population of 1.35 billion people and stands at second most populous position worldwide. India is one of the twelve mega-biodiversity countries of the world. From 70 percent of geographical area surveyed so far by the Botanical Survey of India, Zoological Survey of India and Forest Survey of India, about 16,000 plant species and 81,000 animal species have been identified in India. (Ministry of Information and Broadcasting. 2004. 256). According to the World Wildlife Fund, overall industrial roundwood usage in India is currently the 8th highest in the world and could

surpass 70 million square meters annually by 2020. A 2013 report from India's Central Pollution Control Board found that more than 2,700 million litres per day of domestic sewage is discharged by cities located along the Ganges River. The major environmental issues which India is facing are:

- Air pollution from the industries
- Vehicular emissions
- Greenhouse gas emissions
- Chemical and oil pollution
- Municipal solid waste management
- Water pollution from raw sewage
- Slash and burn practices

India is also one of the highly vulnerable countries to global warming because the Indian economy highly depends on climate sensitive sectors like agriculture, water, forest and hydro-power. Further addition to the magnitude of vulnerability is provided by India's densely populated low-lying coastline. The coastline remains under constant threat from climate related disasters including rise in level of sea water.

To combat such vulnerability, India has agreed to the Montreal Protocol in 1992. India has also endorsed UNFCCC in 1993 and consented to the Kyoto Protocol in 2002. India's strategy towards climate change as well as the contribution to global effort to reduce the risk of climate change are noteworthy. As per the study, Climate Change Mitigation in Developing Countries: Brazil, China, India, Mexico, South Africa and Turkey (2002), by Pew Centre, India's growth in energy-related carbon dioxide emissions was reduced over the last decade through economic restructuring, enforcement of existing clean air laws by the nations highest court, and renewable energy programmes. In 2000, energy policy initiatives reduced carbon emissions by 18 million tonnes - over 5 percent of India's gross carbon emissions. About 120 million tonnes of additional carbon mitigation could be achieved over the next decade at a cost between $ 0 to $ 15 per tonne. Major opportunities include improved efficiency in both energy supply and demand, fuel switching from coal to gas, power transmission improvements, and afforestation. The study also finds that China has dramatically reduced its emissions growth rate at a faster rate as compared to India.

According to the Kyoto Protocol of 1997 signed by 37 industrialized countries and the European Union, the goal for 2008-2012 was to reduce the GHGs emissions to 5.2% lower than the 1990 level.

India, as the third largest producer of GHGs is facing tremendous pressures from the international community to meet these targets. India's extensive environmental laws seem to have very little effect in reducing the harmful effects of pollution, MSW, and GHG emissions. One of the reasons could be the major concern of how to safeguard the environment without adversely affecting the country's economic growth and employment levels.

Enthusiasm of developing countries is noteworthy and they are keen to cooperate in the global efforts to stabilise the CO_2 concentration at a desirable level. Most of the developing countries are not resourceful and are less equipped in terms of institutional arrangements to try ET and avail the full benefits of CDM. However, India is in a relatively comfortable position as compared to many developing countries to try ET and CDM flexible mechanism of the protocol. Gupta (2003) observes that if India can "understand and address the problems in using broad market-based approach to environmental management" it may benefit from participating in ET and has a good prospect in CDM. At present, India has no obligation to be a player in ET, however in long run, India can become a major player. Parikh and Parikh (2002) have critically analysed the prospects for CDM. According to them, in general, CDM is attractive and rewarding for developing countries. But the authors have shown their worry with respect to the equity aspect of CDM operations. In absence of reliable carbon price and uncertainty about the future carbon price behaviour, because at present there are no forward or future markets for carbon, the sharing of gains from CDM project may not be equitable between investor firm or a country and the host country. So, in the case of CDM projects, India has to be a smart player. In general, the developing countries will be helped by the CDM on a large scale.

Since 1987, through Montreal Protocol, much is achieved by the international community but still, the stratospheric ozone layer is not safe. India has honoured the Protocol along with its London Amendment in 1992. Ministry has established an Ozone Cell to cooperate in this respect and has taken also appropriate measures. (Ministry of Information and Broadcasting. 2004:272). The role of international environmental management regimes becomes instrumental for developing countries like India. For example, the UN Conference on Human Environment at Stockholm in 1972 inspired Indian government to set up a National Committee on Environmental Planning and Co-ordination. As a result, the Parliament passed a few acts. Further, the government also framed rules on the basis of these acts e.g., (a) Air and Water Pollution, (b) Forest Conservation, and (c) Wildlife Protection. In late 70s and early 80s, it was all about environmental planning and co-operation. Even till 1986, there was no Ministry at the Centre to guard the environment and the forests. There was no National

Environment Policy in India till 2006. It was adopted for the first time in 2006 after about 60 years of India's independence. But also, many investors and venture capitalists are now seeing India as the 'next big thing' for clean technology investments. According to a 2014 report from the World Bank, ecosystem degradation in India currently costs the country $80 billion annually, or 5.7 percent of GDP. If the country wants to break the cycle of environmental loss and resource depletion, it must further embrace clean technology and sustainable policies, the World Bank said.

There is a lot of talk about the far right at the international political scenario at present. One can also think that globalisation is responsible for the rise of the far-right. Prudence requires that Indian policymakers plan economy's major strategies on the assumption that the rightward swing will continue. This might lead to the West becoming an economic and security fortress. On the economic front, this poses three challenges for India: (a) coping with rising protectionism and reduced foreign direct investment flows; (b) accelerating domestic demand growth; and (c) building up intellectual capital.

At the front of environmental diplomacy, the West has only paid lip service to principles like 'common but differentiated responsibility' and the 'polluter pays principle'. It is a common expectation that India and China must do more.

Check Your Progress Exercise 2

Note: i) Use the space given below for your answer.

ii) See the end of the unit for tips for your answer.

1) Explain the role of North-South knowledge divide in misrepresentation of global environmental issues.

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2) Enlist the environmental concerns of India and discuss briefly how has India contributed in the fight against environmental degradation?

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14.6 SOLUTION TO THE ENVIRONMENTAL PROBLEMS

Some of the environmental problems are spread across political boundaries. A local or regional environmental problem may have implications for the global environmental. On the other hand, some global environmental problems can only be solved through local initiative. We have discussed at length that the increasing pace of globalization has harmful effects on the environment and this has been a major global concern. For managing globalization and the global environment we need global and regional governance. Efficient and effective mechanisms are to be developed which can check the impact on the environment. Governments and individuals need to show strong will for the genuine implementation of the existing mechanisms, particularly in India. Some researchers also believe that the solution to the problem lies in the problem itself i.e., the globalisation can provide the support structure which will be economically feasible and environment friendly. Globalization involves the movement of manufactured goods as well as the transfer of intermediate goods, capital goods and technologies. Multinational corporations with clean state-of-the-art technologies can transfer their green know-how to the countries with low environmental standards.

Due to high consumption levels, humanity's ecological footprint has increased to the point where the Earth is unable to keep up in the struggle to regenerate. The key to resolving this challenge is to de-link consumption from growth, and growth from development. With the clean technologies and environmental initiatives launched by Europe, U.K and Sweden, we can say that the key actors have begun to recognize and some have started to implement the notion of constrained consumption. It is required to provide the poor with the opportunity to increase their use of resources while the affluent reduce their share in order to achieve sustainable global equity.

However, an important question is whether *deglobalization* would have the opposite impact on the environment. There are mounting anti-globalization sentiments appearing and which have engulfed the Global North. The rise of anti-globalization forces also means less specialization in sectors in which countries have comparative advantages. If every country has to produce to meet its domestic

demand, in other words, it could result in duplication in production processes and therefore an increase in local emissions. Some countries have weaker environment standards as compared to others, this could worsen the global emissions scenario. Deglobalization isolates countries, making them less likely to be responsible for the environment. The gains associated with globalization, on the other hand, can be used as effective bargaining strategies or an incentive to demand environmental accountability from countries hoping to benefit from global trading systems. The policies by the current president of the U.S signals that deglobalizing countries may drift away from sustainable development practices towards industrial policies that are devastating to the environment.

So, it is not very clear at the moment whether anti-globalisation would do wonders for our environment. We are responsible for all the environmental threats we face today and only we can possibly solve them to a great extent, if not completely, if we show our will to do it.

Check Your Progress Exercise 3

Note: i) Use the space given below for your answer.

ii) See the end of the unit for tips for your answer.

1) Do anti-globalisation sentiments rising across the globe provide a key to resolve the problems the countries are facing in context of environment?

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14.7 LET US SUM UP

In this unit we learnt about the relationship between globalisation and the environment. Globalisation has direct as well as indirect effects on environment. The environmental concerns of every nation are linked with global environmental concerns and hence it was imperative to throw some light on them. Such concerns were born out of the recognition that ecological processes do not always respect national boundaries and that environmental problems often have global impacts. Global warming, climate changes, ozone cover depletion, biodiversity conservation are some examples of such global

environmental issues. Global partnership and co-operation are crucial in tackling these issues. And so the global initiatives like UNFCCC and the Kyoto Protocol were discussed.

The developed and developing countries have different views on what constitutes the environmental issues as it was clear after the discussion of North-South knowledge divide. Some steps taken by the U.S, UK, China and Europe were also discussed along with their future orientation. India's active role in the global environmental initiatives like the Kyoto Protocol was explained wherein the role of flexible CDMs was given more importance.

It is an absolute necessity that we take steps and make efforts to maintain the harmony with the environment. Humans will survive on this planet only if we stop ignoring the consequences of our own actions. The moral and spiritual dimension of planetary aspirations may not seem like an appropriate subject for policy discussions, but it lies at the very heart of the type of global society that we want to live in and the type of global society that we are constructing. The proposed solutions have sentiments of anti-globalisation and globalisation both in the background through which the environmental issues can be tackled but the strong will is common in both the school of thoughts. The need of the hour is to create effective policies, their sound implementation and a genuine will to work in this direction.

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14.9 ANSWERS TO CHECK YOUR PROGRESS EXERCISES

Check Your Progress Exercise 1

1) Discuss the emissions from fossil fuel and the categories of indirect effects i.e., composition, scale and technique effects. Read carefully Section 14.2 to write your answer.
2) Your answer should include the discussion about UNFCCC and Kyoto Protocol. Read carefully Section 14.3 to write your answer.

Check Your Progress Exercise 2

1) Discuss the invisibility of the South and the development of data and evidence concentration in North. Read carefully subsection 14.4.1 to write your answer.

2) The list shall include various kinds of pollution present in India. The support and consent of India for UNFCCC and Kyoto Protocol shall be highlighted. Read carefully Section 14.5 to write your answer.

Check Your Progress Exercise 3

1) Give your point of view after assessing the pros and cons of anti-globalisation. Read carefully Section 14.6 to write your answer.

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